

2024



Purina Builds a Strategic Consumer IAM Solution for an Optimized User Journey Using Amazon Cognito

Learn how Purina, a consumer packaged goods and animal nutrition leader, built a consumer identity solution for its services using Amazon Cognito.

[Overview](#) | [Opportunity](#) | [Solution](#) | [Outcome](#) | [AWS Services Used](#)

80% cost savings
compared with other vendor solutions

Created end-to-end authentication
for more than 2 million consumers

Improved consumer experience
with single sign-on



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Overview

[Purina](#), which provides a broad portfolio of consumer packaged goods and animal nutrition products, built a strategic consumer identity solution to streamline access to multiple digital services for its consumers. The company has 14 digital services to help more



than two million pet owners with tasks such as buying food, treats, and litter on the company website and monitoring a smart litter box with the Petivity app. But consumers who wanted to access any of those 14 distinct services had to create independent accounts for each one.

Purina wanted to help its consumers navigate seamlessly between its digital services and to consolidate its view of consumers, including behaviors and preferences expressed across its products and services. On Amazon Web Services (AWS), Purina developed a bespoke consumer identity and access management (CIAM) solution with single sign-on (SSO) and applied it to one of Purina’s apps in 4 months. It cost one-fifth of what third-party vendors proposed for using their identity management solutions. Purina plans for its CIAM solution to be integrated into three additional digital services by the end of 2024 as it works toward integrating all its digital services.

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Opportunity | Using AWS to Build a Cloud-Based CIAM Solution

Purina has been producing pet food and pet care products for more than a century. Since 2018, it has expanded into digital products and an array of pet nutrition products. As its offerings multiplied, Purina sought to develop a frictionless digital environment where consumers could discover all the company’s services through one account.

In 2022, Purina set its sights on developing a robust CIAM solution with SSO to drive better consumer usability across its digital services. “SSO removes the barriers between apps and lets consumers move in and out of other products to get deeper support than we could offer before,” says Annie Scharenberg, director of architecture and services at Purina US. The company turned to [AWS Professional Services](#), a global team of experts that helps users achieve their desired business outcomes. Purina already had a strong relationship with AWS Professional Services, which had guided the company to success on earlier projects.

After consulting with the AWS Professional Services team, Purina decided that, instead of using third-party customer identity solutions, which have greater limitations and fewer customization options, they would build a custom tool using a suite of AWS services. This helped Purina design a cost-effective system with a better user experience.

consumer outreach and engagement. Because the company had experience using AWS, the new CIAM solution and SSO features fit well with the company's existing cloud-native workflows, resulting in a more streamlined development cycle.

Purina built an omnichannel, dynamic relationship with its consumers. AWS experts advised Purina on which AWS capabilities would serve Purina's needs and where the company could scale and create cost efficiency on AWS. "As Purina identifies strategic opportunities to benefit users, working with the AWS team helps achieve those initiatives," says Scharenberg.

Solution | Achieving 80% Cost Savings by Using Amazon Cognito

A consumer's first contact with Purina's digital services is through the front-end SSO interface on the MyPurina app. The cornerstone of Purina's CIAM solution is [Amazon Cognito](#), which developers use to add user sign-up and sign-in features and control access to their web and mobile applications. The CIAM solution connects Purina's pet adoption sites, Internet of Things devices, companion apps, pet care mobile apps, and consumer loyalty solutions. To create a standardized experience for Purina consumers, the development team also uses [AWS Amplify](#), which lets developers build full-stack web and mobile apps. Purina deploys a suite of other AWS services in support of this stack.

To migrate existing user identities or create new ones, Purina uses [AWS Lambda](#), a serverless, event-driven compute service that can run code for virtually any type of application. "We were challenged to create a custom SSO capability that can tap into another solution, discover if there's an existing user account, and either link it through SSO or dynamically generate a new account without impacting system performance," says Scharenberg. To store user data and credentials, Purina uses [Amazon DynamoDB](#), a database service that can deliver apps with consistent single-digit millisecond performance and nearly unlimited storage. "We needed the solution to propagate credentials across our products, so we needed storage," says Scharenberg.

After kicking off development in October 2022, the MyPurina mobile app went live in February 2023, becoming one of Purina's fastest-released services. With its custom SSO solution, Purina created a seamless consumer experience that links user accounts with standalone applications using independent user stores. By using AWS Cognito advanced security features to achieve fraud prevention, Purina centralized security for all its products in one solution. And since the SSO feature was customized, Purina has achieved 80 percent cost savings over using out-of-the-box products by paying only for features that it needs.

The new solution provides Purina with increased security, reduced data collection and duplication, and improved consumer experience. Purina also saved time on architecture security reviews under contract with the company, Nestlé USA. Although these typically take at least 3 months to complete, Purina accomplished it in 1



month. “Using Purina’s overarching technical strategy and expertise in the cloud, combined with the advantage of using AWS ProServ on AWS solutions, we could save valuable time and deliver faster,” says Scharenberg.

Outcome | Extending CIAM to Purina’s Full Digital Services Portfolio

Using AWS solutions is helping Purina build relationships with its consumers by paving the way for individual recommendations, personalized offers, and even proactive health opportunities. For example, the Petivity Smart Litter Box Monitor proactively generates insights on changes in a cat’s litter box behavior, and alerts the owners to potential problems.

Purina plans to expand its CIAM solution even further to three more applications—Petivity, Petfinder, and Purina.com—by the end of 2023. The company is excited about the new ways it can use its digital properties to improve the lives of its consumers and their pets. “SSO is the technical linchpin that will help us open the floodgates to opportunities and business strategies that didn’t exist for us without it,” says Scharenberg.

About Purina

Purina is a leader in pet wellness and nutrition, pursuing innovation in animal nutrition and pet welfare. The company serves more than 2 million pet owners.

AWS Services Used

Amazon Cognito

Amazon Cognito helps you implement customer identity and access management (CIAM) into your web and mobile applications. You can quickly add user authentication and access control to your applications in minutes.

[Learn more »](#)

AWS Amplify

Amplify is everything you need to build full-stack web and mobile apps on AWS. Build and host your frontend, add features like auth and storage, connect to real-time data sources, deploy, and scale to millions of users.

[Learn more »](#)



AWS Lambda

AWS Lambda is a compute service that runs your code in response to events and automatically manages the compute resources, making it the fastest way to turn an idea into a modern, production, serverless applications.

[Learn more »](#)

Amazon DynamoDB

Amazon DynamoDB is a serverless, NoSQL database service that enables you to develop modern applications at any scale.

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